

“[The French] do not treat us as **brothers ...**
they treat us as slaves and ... as **dogs.**”

VIETNAMESE NATIONALIST PHAN BOI CHAU, 1931

» AFTER

The defeat of Japan by the Allies in August 1945 left a power vacuum in Indochina, enabling the Viet Minh to occupy Hanoi.

FIRST INDOCHINA WAR

Ho Chi Minh declared an **independent Democratic Republic of Vietnam** on September 2, 1945. His government enjoyed widespread support in Vietnam, but the French were determined to **reestablish their rule** in Indochina. The failure to negotiate an agreement between France and the Viet Minh led to the **First Indochina War** in December 1946.